Excellent Meatballs

Main dishes | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: sauté pan and baking sheet. Oven: 350°F. Bake: about 15 minutes after browning. Plan ahead: cool the cooked onion mixture completely before mixing with meat.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Garlic and red pepper

Bowl B - Cheese, parsley, and breadcrumbs

- [ ] Extra-virgin olive oil
- [ ] 1 large onion, diced about 1/4 inch
- [ ] Salt
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, chopped [Bowl A]
- [ ] Pinch crushed red pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 lb ground beef
- [ ] 1/2 lb ground veal
- [ ] 1/2 lb ground pork
- [ ] 2 large eggs
- [ ] 1 cup grated Parmigiano [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 cup finely chopped Italian parsley [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 cup breadcrumbs [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 cup water
- [ ] Marinara sauce, for serving

1. Cook and cool the aromatics

1. Coat a large sauté pan with extra-virgin olive oil. Add 1 large onion, diced about 1/4 inch, and salt. Cook over medium-high heat 5-7 minutes, until very soft but not browned.

2. Add 2 chopped garlic cloves and a pinch of crushed red pepper. Cook 1-2 minutes, then let the mixture cool completely.

2. Mix and shape

1. Combine 1/2 lb ground beef, 1/2 lb ground veal, 1/2 lb ground pork, 2 large eggs, 1 cup grated Parmigiano, 1/4 cup finely chopped Italian parsley, and 1 cup breadcrumbs.

2. Mix in the cooled onion mixture and season generously with salt. Add 1/2 cup water and mix thoroughly; the mixture should be quite moist.

3. Cook a small tester patty and adjust seasoning if needed.

4. Heat the oven to 350°F. Shape meatballs slightly larger than golf balls.

3. Brown and bake

1. Brown the meatballs on all sides in olive oil over medium-high heat, working in batches.

2. Transfer to a baking sheet and bake about 15 minutes, until cooked through. Serve with marinara.

Notes

Make-ahead option from the saved recipe: cool the cooked meatballs and freeze for later.